Pratik Praveen Mehta

Supply Chain, Sourcing & Product Leader | Supplier Strategy, Catalog Platforms, Forecasting & AI

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PROFILE SUMMARY

Supply chain and product leader with 12+ years across the automotive aftermarket, supply chain consulting, and manufacturing. Owns private-label accessories and towing categories end to end, including sourcing, supplier negotiation (tooling and non-recurring engineering), new product introduction, and lifecycle management, with $10M+ in annual spend within a $125M portfolio. Owns the roadmap for a catalog management portal serving 30,000+ customers and 120+ suppliers. Secured a 2% cost reduction on $25M, freed $15M+ in working capital, and built forecasting models and AI agents that improve planning decisions. Leads 4 direct and 3 indirect reports and briefs executives up to the CFO and CEO. B.E. Electrical Engineering and MBA; Lean Six Sigma Green Belt.

CORE SKILLS

Sourcing & Supplier Management: Strategic Sourcing, RFI/RFQ/RFP, Contract Negotiation, Total Cost of Ownership, Tooling & NRE, Contract Manufacturers, AVL Qualification, Corrective Action Plans, Supplier Performance

Product & Lifecycle: Roadmap Ownership, PRDs & User Stories, New Product Introduction, Catalog & Product Data, Product Supersession, End-of-Life & Excess Inventory, A/B Testing, Jira, Aha!

Data, Analytics & AI: SQL, Python, PyCaret, ML Forecasting, Tableau, Power BI, Qlik Sense, SAP SAC, AI Agent Development

Planning Systems & Leadership: SAP IBP, SAP Procurement, Kinaxis, Custom ERP, Lean Six Sigma, Cross-Functional Leadership, Executive Communication

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Business Process Specialist — Supply Chain Strategy & Operations — LKQ Corporation **May 2023 – Present**

San Jose, CA

- Own the private-label accessories and towing categories (floor mats, mirror covers, wheel covers, bumpers, tonneau covers), managing $10M+ in annual spend across suppliers and contract manufacturers; run RFI/RFQ/RFP processes and TCO models and negotiate contracts through signature.
- Secured a 2% cost reduction on $25M in spend through supplier cost-sharing and tooling and non-recurring engineering negotiation; freed $15M+ in working capital by redesigning end-of-life and excess inventory strategy.
- Own the strategy and roadmap for a catalog management portal used by 30,000+ customers and 120+ suppliers, writing PRDs and user stories and working with engineers through release and UAT; built dashboards and a KPI tracking system and reached a 92% data completeness score, with brands recognized at SEMA Gold level for data quality.
- Lead new product introduction and supersession and lifecycle decisions for private-label parts; ran A/B tests on promotions, price elasticity, and launch strategies.
- Escalation point for supplier quality and delivery issues through Critical Action Plans; manage AVL qualification and supplier performance.
- Configured 3 AI agents (competitor price tracking, marketing asset creation, forecast accuracy & insights); apply statistical and ML forecasting.
- Lead 4 direct and 3 indirect reports with a formal intake, prioritization, and delivery governance process; brief the VP, SVP, CFO, and CEO using Tableau and Power BI dashboards across 15 private-label brands.

Inventory Process Specialist — Supply Chain Optimization — LKQ Corporation **Oct 2021 – Mar 2023**

Bengaluru, India

- Built a Python- and SQL-driven forecasting engine across 6,000+ SKUs that lifted rolling 52-week forecast accuracy from 53% to 74%, and a scenario simulation platform for real-time supply and demand risk.
- Led a Tableau BI transformation that cut reporting turnaround by 70% and raised adoption across 20+ FTEs.
- Led and developed 4 direct and 3 indirect reports (Business Analysts), owning dashboards, MIS reporting, and SQL data warehousing.

Senior Consultant — Supply Chain Analytics & Transformation — Bristlecone Ltd. **Jun 2019 – Sep 2021**

Bengaluru, India

- Owned the roadmap of Rapid Insights 360, a supply chain analytics product, and led a 5-member team from prototype to commercial offerings on the SAP App Center; built reusable accelerators and dashboards in Power BI, Tableau, Qlik Sense, and SAP SAC.
- Ran pre-sales and demos across CPG, semiconductor, healthcare, financial services, and energy, and led 3+ engagements ($500K–$2M) from proposals through delivery.
- Advised on SAP IBP and Kinaxis implementations and built ML forecasting models with PyCaret.

Front Lead Engineer — Ultratech Cements — Aditya Birla Group **Sep 2015 – Apr 2018**
Multiple Locations, India

- Built SAP-based MIS dashboards that helped reduce working capital in slow-moving assets by 28%; led a Lean Six Sigma DMAIC project saving INR 1.5 Cr annually and cutting energy use by 1.3 kWh/ton.

Software Engineer — Tech Mahindra **Jun 2014 – Sep 2015**
Pune, India

- Owned end-to-end delivery of a reporting dashboard for a US telecom client, from development through client-facing support.

EDUCATION

Great Lakes Institute of Management, Chennai, India — Post Graduate Program (MBA), Marketing
Government College of Engineering, Chandrapur (R.T.M. Nagpur University), India — Bachelor of Engineering, Electrical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS & ACHIEVEMENTS

- Lean Six Sigma Green Belt; Certified Supply Chain Professional (CSCP) — in progress
- “Best Kaizen” award (twice) and “Most Valuable Member” award, LKQ Corporation
- “Beautiful Mind” and “Core Values in Action” awards, Bristlecone